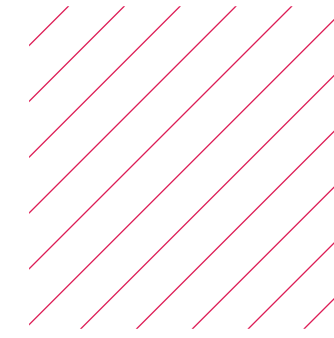




CI INSTITUTE OF NURSING

CERTIFIED NURSE
ASSISTANT TRAINING PROGRAM



Module 13: Long Term Patient/Resident

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MODULE 13: LONG TERM PATIENT/RESIDENT

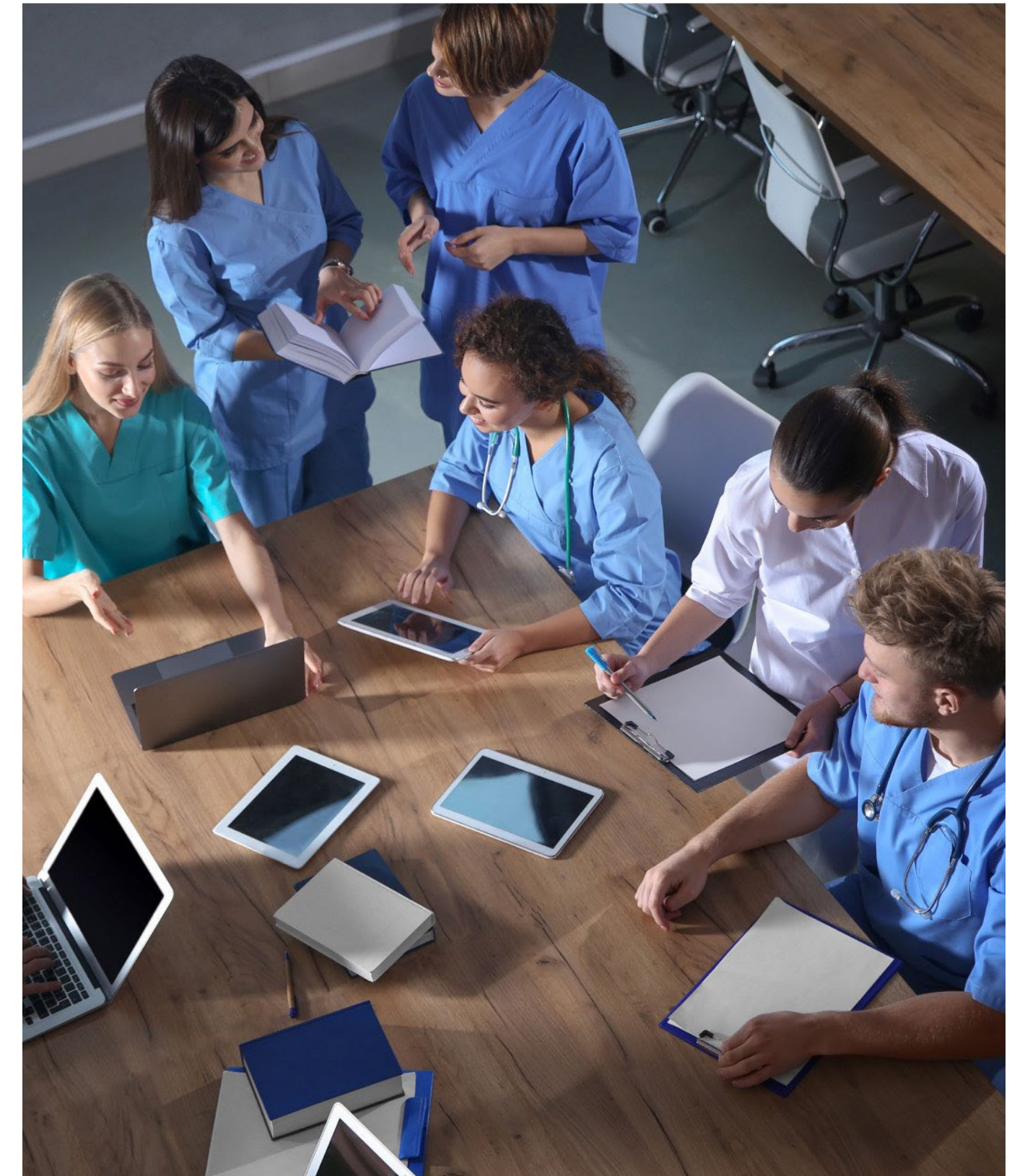
Minimum Number of Theory Hours:

13

Recommended Clinical Hours:

4

Module 13: Long Term Patient/Resident

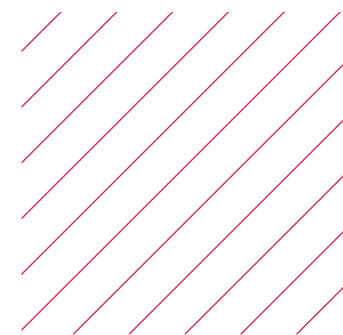


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STATEMENT OF PURPOSE

The purpose of this unit is to introduce the student to the basic structure of the body and to review the effect of aging on body structure and function. Common physical and psychological conditions found in elderly patients are presented along with approaches to care. Community resources commonly available to assist elderly patients with their psychological, recreational, and social needs are presented.



TERMINOLOGY:

Long Term Care Resident:

1. Acute
2. Assisted living
3. Chronic
4. Debilitating
5. Dementia
6. Long-term care
7. Reality orientation
8. Reminiscing
9. Patients/residents
10. Skilled nursing facility
11. Subacute care
12. Validation therapy

Medical and Anatomical Terms:

13. Anatomic position
14. Anatomy
15. Anterior
16. Cells
17. Connective tissue
18. Contractures
19. Disease
20. Distal

21. Epithelial tissue

22. Health

23. Inferior

24. Joints

25. Lateral

26. Membranes

27. Muscle tissue

28. Nerve tissue

29. Organ

30. Peritoneum

31. Physiology

32. Posterior

33. Prefix

34. Proximal

35. Suffix

36. Superior

37. System

38. Traction

Nervous System:

39. Age-related Macular Degeneration (AMD)

40. Agitated

41. Alzheimer's disease

42. Aphasia

43. Autonomic dysreflexia

44. Bipolar disorder

45. Brain

46. Cataract

47. Catastrophic reaction

48. Cerebral palsy

49. Cerebral Vascular Accident (CVA)

50. Concussion

51. Confusion

52. Delirium

53. Delusion

54. Dementia

55. Developmentally disabled

56. Disruptive behavior

57. Elopement

58. Epilepsy

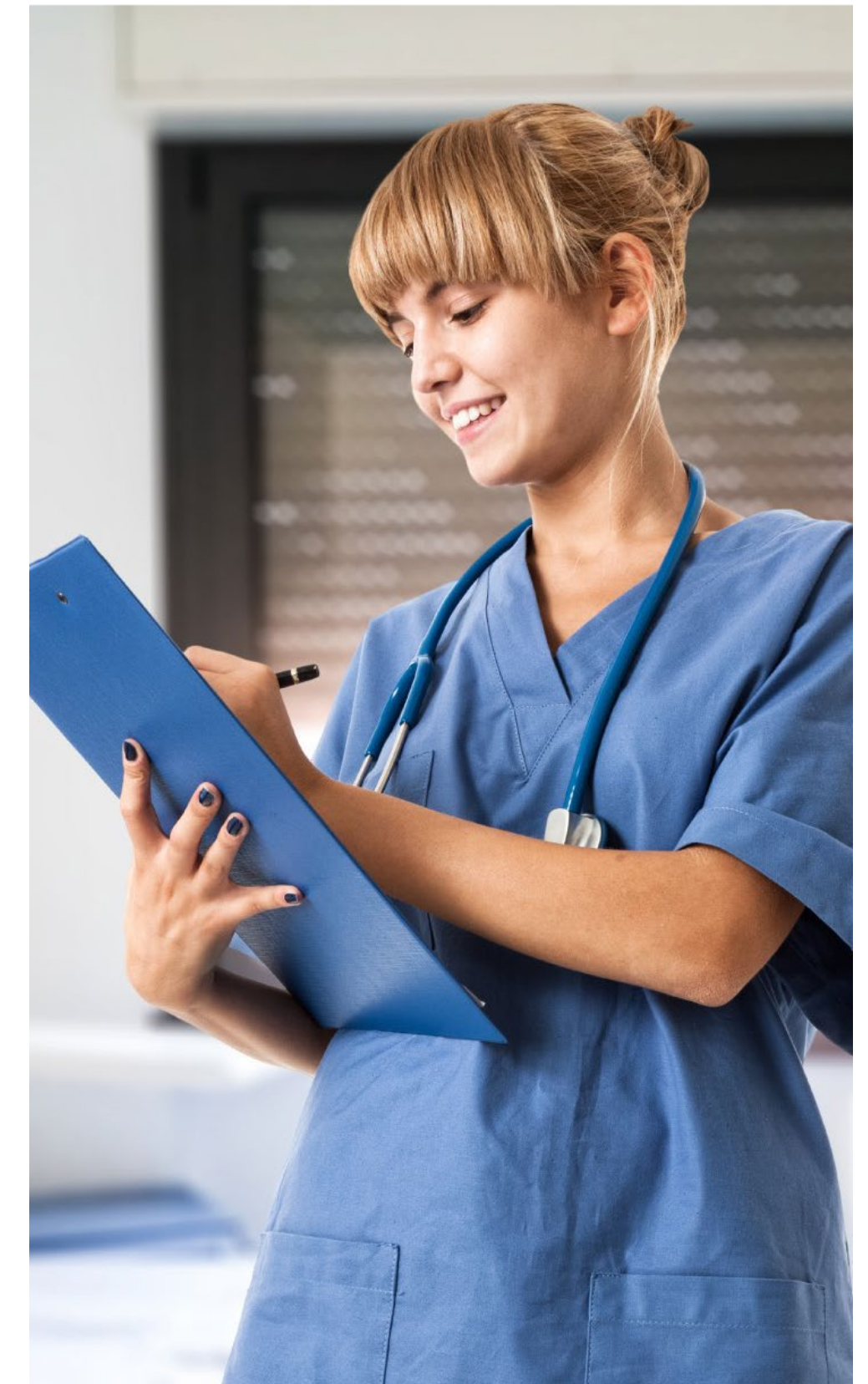
59. Generalized anxiety

60. Glaucoma

61. Hallucination

62. Hemianopsia

63. Hemiplegia



Patient, resident, and client are synonymous terms referring to the person receiving care

Module 13: Long Term Patient/Resident

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TERMINOLOGY:

- 64. Multiple sclerosis
- 65. Nerve
- 66. Neuron
- 67. Otosclerosis
- 68. Panic disorder
- 69. Paralysis
- 70. Paranoia
- 71. Paranoid schizophrenia
- 72. Paraplegia
- 73. Parkinson's disease
- 74. Peripheral nervous system
- 75. Post-traumatic stress syndrome
- 76. Quadriplegia
- 77. Reality orientation
- 78. Seizure
- 79. Stroke
- 80. Sundowner syndrome
- 81. Transient Ischemic Attack (TIA)
- 82. Tremor
- 83. Vertigo

Immune System:

- 84. Antibody
- 85. Antigen
- 86. Auto Immunodeficiency Syndrome (AIDS)
- 87. Carrier
- 88. Human Immunodeficiency Virus
- 89. Immunity
- 90. Lymph node

- 91. T-cell
- 92. White blood cell

Cardiovascular System:

- 93. Anemia
- 94. Angina
- 95. Anti-embolic stockings
- 96. Artery
- 97. Atherosclerosis
- 98. Blood
- 99. Capillary
- 100. Congestive Heart Failure (CHF)
- 101. Coronary artery disease
- 102. Dyspnea
- 103. Edema
- 104. Embolism
- 105. Heart
- 106. Hypertension
- 107. Hypoxia
- 108. Ischemia
- 109. Myocardial infarction
- 110. Orthopnea
- 111. Pacemaker
- 112. Peripheral vascular disease (PVD)
- 113. Phlebitis
- 114. Pulmonary edema
- 115. Sequential compression device (SCD)
- 116. Systole
- 117. Thrombus
- 118. Varicose vein

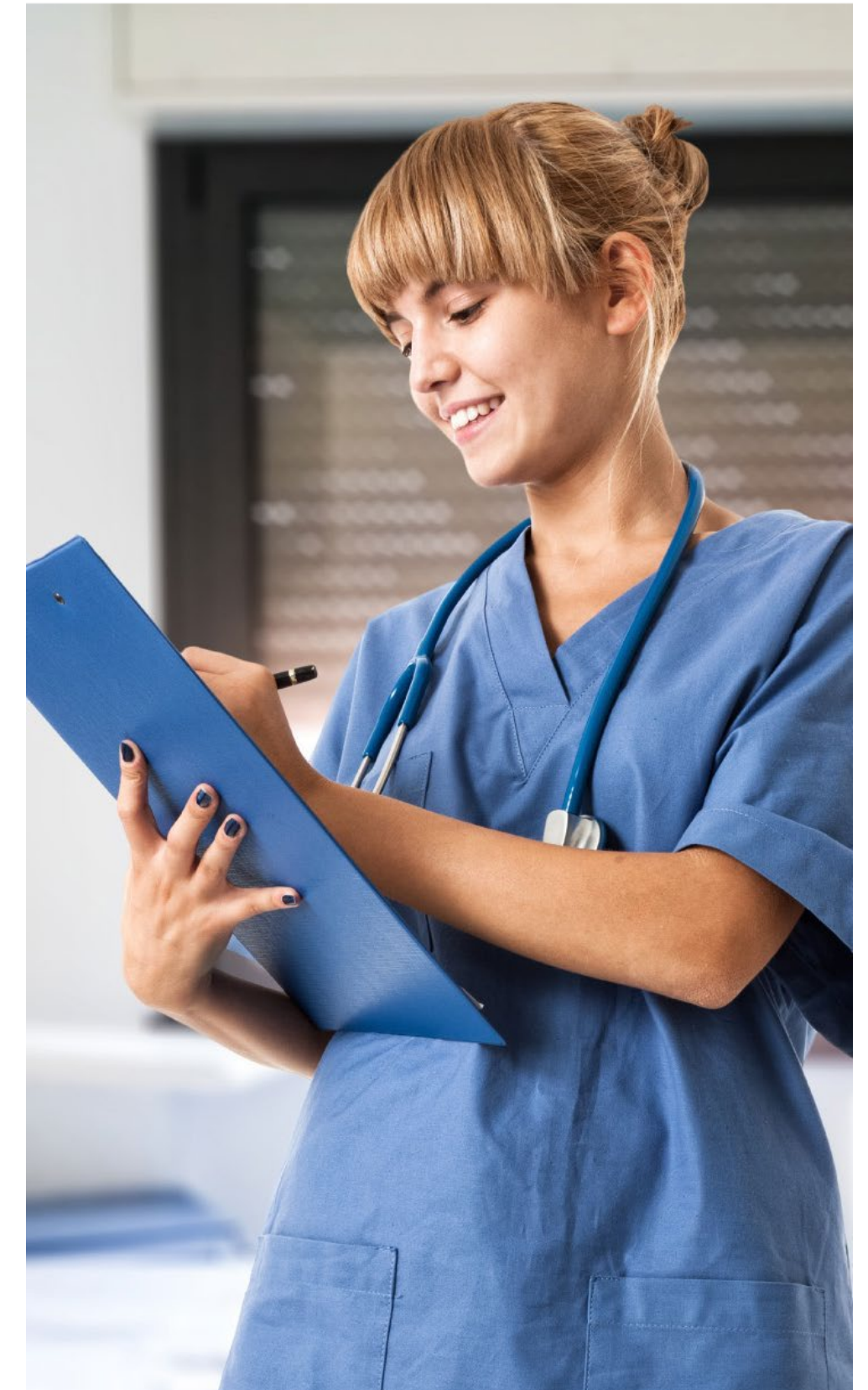
- 119. Vein
- 120. Vessel

Integumentary System:

- 121. Abrasion
- 122. Allergies
- 123. Bony prominences
- 124. Cyanotic
- 125. Debride
- 126. Decubitus ulcer
- 127. Dermis
- 128. Epidermis
- 129. Excoriation
- 130. Friction
- 131. Gangrene
- 132. Hematoma
- 133. Lesion
- 134. Necrosis
- 135. Pallor
- 136. Pediculosis
- 137. Pressure ulcer
- 138. Pruritus
- 139. Psoriasis
- 140. Scabies
- 141. Shearing
- 142. Skin
- 143. Skin tears

Gastrointestinal System:

- 144. Absorption
- 145. Bile
- 146. Bowel movement
- 147. Colon
- 148. Colostomy



TERMINOLOGY:

- 149. Constipation
- 150. Defecation
- 151. Diarrhea
- 152. Digestion
- 153. Diverticulitis
- 154. Elimination
- 155. Enema
- 156. Fecal impaction
- 157. Feces
- 158. Flatus
- 159. Gastrectomy
- 160. Gastric tube
- 161. Hernia
- 162. Ileostomy
- 163. Nasogastric tube (NG)
- 164. Obstruction
- 165. Occult blood
- 166. Ostomy
- 167. Percutaneous Endoscopic Gastrostomy (PEG)
- 168. Peristalsis
- 169. Stoma
- 170. Stool
- 171. Suppository
- 172. Ulcer
- 173. Urgency
- 174. Urostomy

Respiratory System:

- 175. Alveoli
- 176. Asthma
- 177. Bronchi
- 178. Carbon dioxide

- 179. Chronic Heart Failure (CHF)
- 180. Chronic Obstructive Pulmonary Disease (COPD)
- 181. Dyspnea
- 182. Emphysema
- 183. Expiration
- 184. Inspiration
- 185. Larynx
- 186. Lungs
- 187. Mucous
- 188. Nasal cannula
- 189. Nebulizer
- 190. Orthopnea
- 191. Oxygen mask
- 192. Pharynx
- 193. Pneumonia
- 194. Sputum
- 195. Tracheostomy
- 196. Tuberculosis (TB)
- 197. Upper respiratory infection (URI)

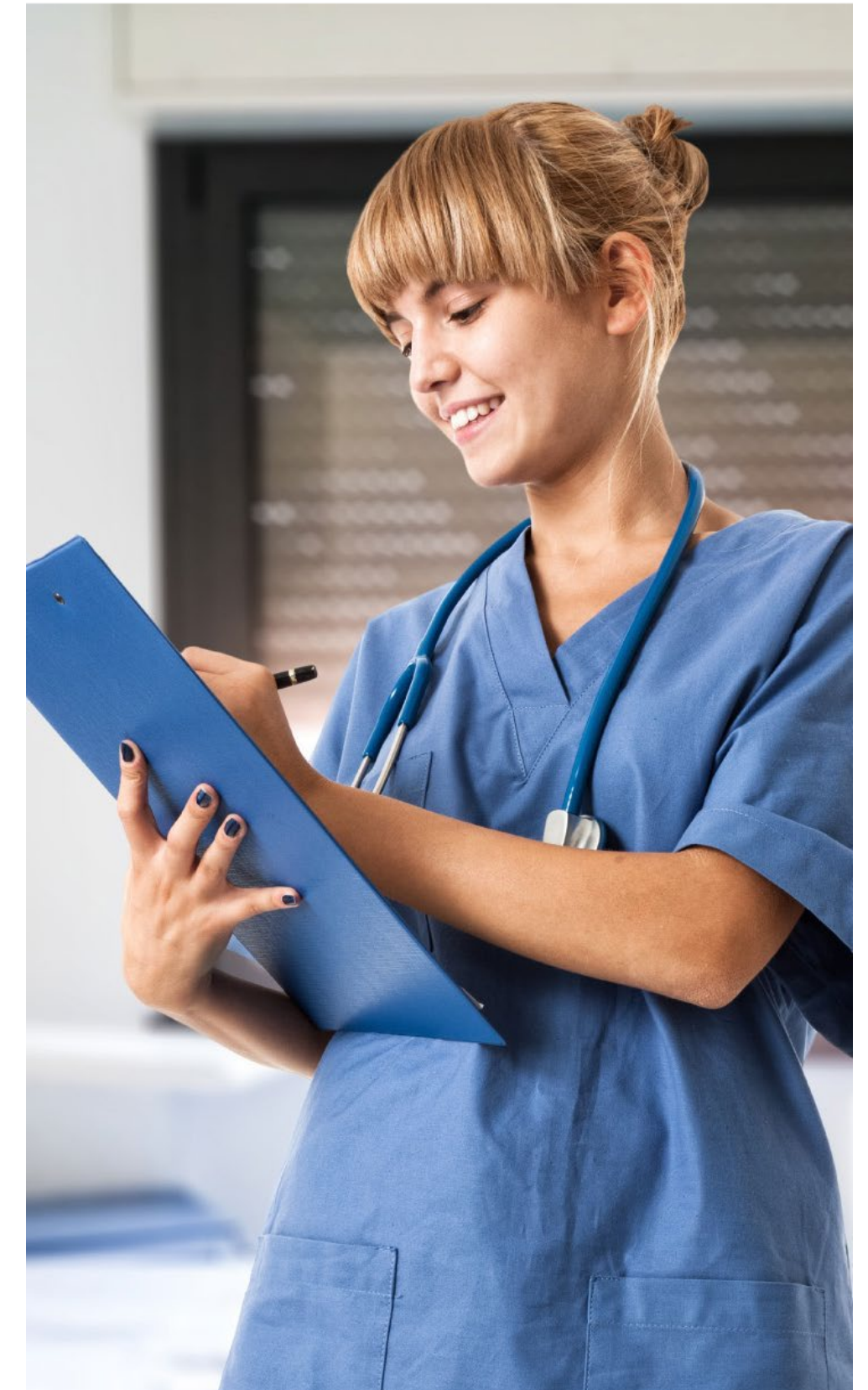
Musculoskeletal System:

- 198. Abduction
- 199. Adduction
- 200. Amputation
- 201. Arthritis
- 202. Atrophy
- 203. Bursitis
- 204. Contracture
- 205. Extension
- 206. Flexion
- 207. Fracture

- 208. Full weight-bearing (FWB)
- 209. Gout
- 210. Muscle
- 211. Muscular dystrophy
- 212. Osteoarthritis
- 213. Osteoporosis
- 214. Phantom pain
- 215. Pronation
- 216. Prosthesis
- 217. Range of Motion (ROM)
- 218. Rheumatoid arthritis
- 219. Rotation
- 220. Skeleton
- 221. Supination
- 222. Total hip arthroplasty
- 223. Trapeze
- 224. Vertebrae

Urinary System

- 225. Catheter
- 226. Calculi
- 227. Chronic renal failure
- 228. Clean catch
- 229. Condom catheter
- 230. Cystitis
- 231. Dialysis
- 232. Diuresis
- 233. Dysuria
- 234. End-Stage Renal Disease (ESRD)
- 235. Hematuria
- 236. Indwelling catheter
- 237. Kidney



TERMINOLOGY:

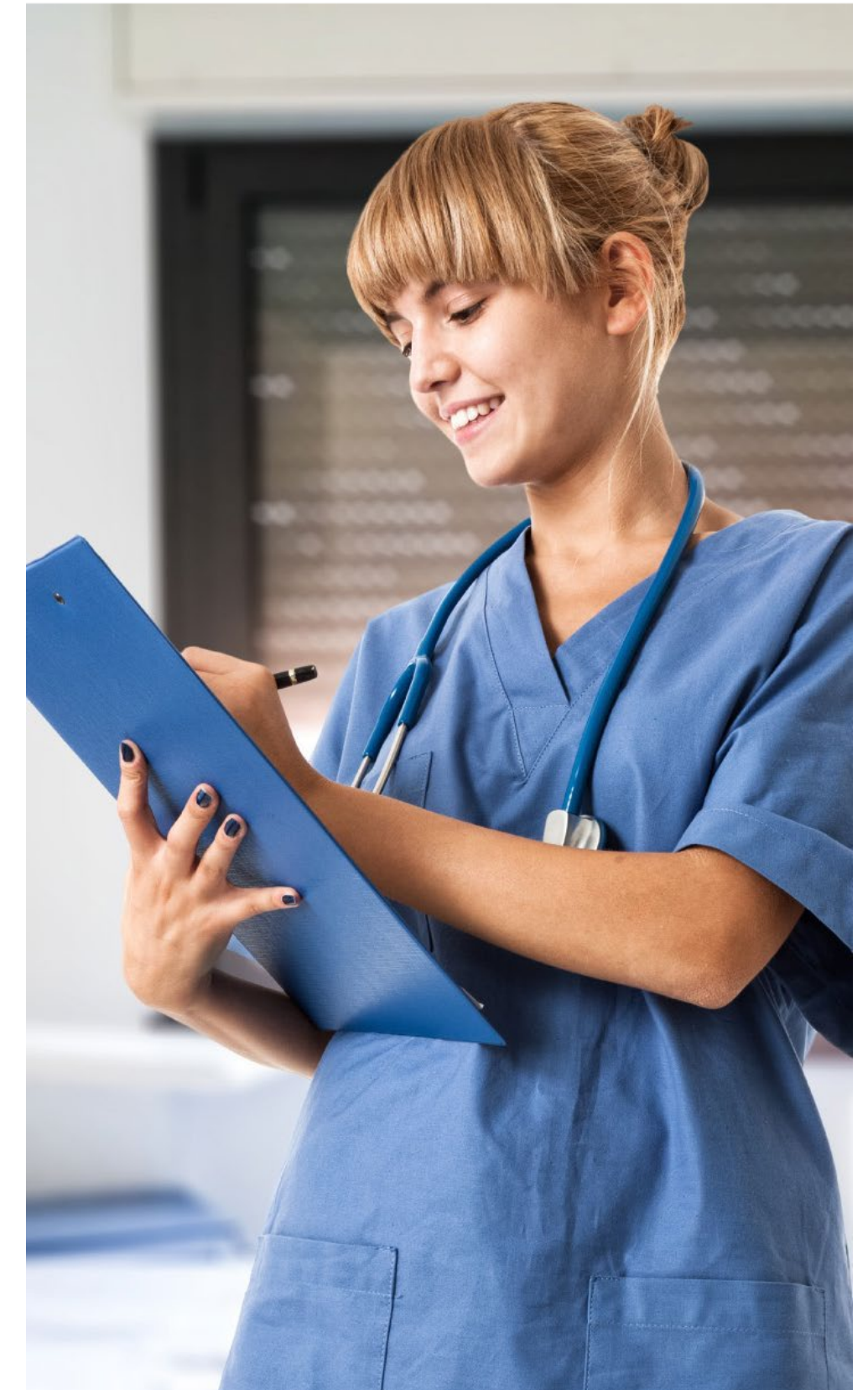
- 238. Micturition
- 239. Nephritis
- 240. Renal calculi
- 241. Retention
- 242. Specimens
- 243. Ureter
- 244. Urethra
- 245. Urinalysis
- 246. Urinary bladder
- 247. Urinary drainage bag
- 248. Urinary incontinence
- 249. Urinary Tract Infection (UTI)
- 250. Void

Reproductive System:

- 251. Benign prostatic hypertrophy
- 252. Chlamydia
- 253. Cystocele
- 254. Douche
- 255. Genitalia
- 256. Genital herpes

- 257. Human Papilloma Virus(HPV)
- 258. Gonorrhea
- 259. Hemorrhoid
- 260. Herpes simplex 2
- 261. Hormones
- 262. Hysterectomy
- 263. Mammogram
- 264. Mastectomy
- 265. Pelvis Inflammatory disease (PID)
- 266. Penis
- 267. Prostate gland
- 268. Rectocele
- 269. Sexually transmitted disease (STD)
- 270. Syphilis
- 271. Testes
- 272. Trichomoniasis
- 273. Uterus
- 274. Vagina

- 275. Venereal
 - 276. Vulvovaginitis
- ## **Endocrine System:**
- 277. Diabetes mellitus
 - 278. Fasting Blood Sugar (FBS)
 - 279. Glucose
 - 280. Glycosuria
 - 281. Goiter
 - 282. Hormones
 - 283. Hyperglycemia
 - 284. Hypoglycemia
 - 285. Insulin
 - 286. Insulin-Dependent Diabetes Mellitus (IDDM)
 - 287. Metabolism
 - 288. Non-Insulin-Dependent Diabetes Mellitus (NIDDM)
 - 289. Pituitary gland
 - 290. Thyroxine



Patient, resident, and client are synonymous terms referring to the person receiving care



PERFORMANCE STANDARDS

Upon completion of five (5) hours SNF/ICF* or three (3) non-SNF/ICF of class plus homework assignments and four (4) hours of clinical experience, the learner will be able to:**

1. Define key terminology
2. Describe common basic human needs, changes, and interventions for the elderly patient/resident; environmental/physical, psychological, social/behavioral, recreational and spiritual
3. Describe common community resources to meet the needs of the elderly
4. Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness
5. Describe the special needs of persons with Alzheimer's Disease and other related dementias
6. Describe the body's basic organization and composition
7. List the body systems, including basic anatomy and physiology, common diseases of the elderly with signs and symptoms, Nurse Assistant duties and observations, aging changes and complications of immobility
8. Describe changes in body systems associated with aging



/// DEFINE KEY TERMINOLOGY

- A. Review the terms listed in the terminology section
- B. Spell the listed terms accurately
- C. Pronounce the terms correctly
- D. Use the terms in their proper context



Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

A. Epilepsy/Seizure Disorders

1. Description of different types of Epilepsy and Seizure Disorders

- a. Generalized seizure (Grand mal)
- b. Partial seizure (Petit mal)
- c. Absent Seizure
- d. Status epilepticus

2. Discuss potential causes

- a. Metabolic disorders
- b. Nutrition problems
- c. Medication problems

3. Signs/symptoms (Refer to objective 7)

- a. Depends on type of seizure
- b. May experience "aura" or certain taste before Entire body is involved
- c. May experience loss of consciousness
- d. Incontinence
- e. May be followed by period of fatigue, confusion, disorientation

4. Nurse Assistant duties and responsibilities

- a. Stay with person and call for assistance
- b. Assist to lay down
- c. Do not restrain movements or put anything in mouth
- d. Move away objects that may injure a person
- e. Maintain airway by loosening clothing, turn head so saliva/emesis drains to one side, lift shoulder and allow head to tilt back

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

B. Parkinson's Disease

1. Description and progression of disease

- a. Progressive nervous system disorder that affects movement
- b. Early stages of Parkinson's disease, may be mild and go unnoticed, but as symptoms worsen as the condition progresses over time
- c. Certain nerve cells (neurons) in the brain gradually break down or die, which causes a loss of neurons that produce a chemical messenger in your brain called dopamine

2. Signs and symptoms

- a. Start gradually, sometimes starting with a barely noticeable tremor in just one hand
- b. Tremors and "pill rolling"
- c. Muscle rigidity
- d. Shuffling manner of walking Difficulty and slowness in carrying out voluntary motor activities
- e. Slurred speech
- f. Loss of expressiveness in face

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

- g. Drooling
- h. Incontinence
- i. Constipation
- j. Urinary retention
- k. Mood swings
- l. Depression
- m. Fatigue

3. Nurse Assistant duties and responsibilities

- a. Safety activities and concerns
- b. Nutrition problems including swallowing and/or chewing issues
- c. Notify licensed nurse if behavior worsens or becomes dangerous
- d. Maintain calm environment; symptoms will worsen when patient/resident is under stress
- e. Assist in ADLs

- f. Provide emotional support
- g. Restorative care; exercises
- h. Dementia care; as above

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

C. Schizophrenia

1. Mental disorder characterized by paranoia, hallucinations, delusions, bizarre behavior and distortions of reality
2. Signs/symptoms
3. Nurse Assistant duties and responsibilities
 - a. Notify licensed nurse if behavior worsens or becomes dangerous
 - b. Do not “feed in” to delusions, but do not try to convince them of reality
 - c. Be aware of suicide precautions
 - d. Keep patient/resident involved in reality activities
 - e. Report and document observed responses to medication and psychotherapy
 - f. Monitor nutrition and fluid balance - these patients/residents often refuse to eat or drink out of a fear of poisoning
 - g. Find ways of reducing patient's/resident's fear and anxiety

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

D. Hypochondriasis

1. Patient/resident imagines or magnifies each physical ailment
2. Nurse Assistant duties and responsibilities
 - a. Be supportive, some authorities feel this disorder stems from depression
 - b. Do not overlook real illness; report all complaints
 - c. Do not judge

E. Depression

1. Most common functional disorder in older people
2. Signs and Symptoms
 - a. Feeling of sadness
 - b. Lack of interest in and withdrawal from environment
 - c. Feelings of worthlessness
 - d. Negative outlook on the future

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

3. Nurse Assistant duties and responsibilities

- a. Notify licensed nurse if patient/resident displays loss of appetite, weight loss, severe fatigue, crying, or sleeplessness
- b. Notify licensed nurse if patient/resident makes statements such as "I wish I could just die"
- c. Remain non-judgmental
- d. Listen with empathy
- e. Encourage activities with others
- f. Encourage aerobic activity, as well as outdoor activities (releases endorphins)

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

E. Suicidal patient/resident

1. The elderly patients/residents are at risk of suicidal behavior, especially white males over the age of 65 who live alone, and the very old (75 years and above)
2. Nurse Assistant duties and responsibilities
 - a. Report clues of suicide attempts to licensed nurse
 - b. Give constant care
 - c. Monitor activities
 - d. Work to preserve self-esteem
 - e. Help patient/resident find support network; friends, clergy, family and support groups
 - f. Never ignore the person's statements or threats about suicide

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

F. Intellectual or Developmental Disabilities

1. Significant sub-average intellectual function and low adaptive ability
2. Nurse Assistant duties and responsibilities
 - a. Provide an environment as normal as possible (normalization)
 - b. Emphasize individual strengths
 - c. Encourage independence, self-care
 - d. Treat with dignity at age appropriate level
 - e. Respect privacy
 - f. Provide safe, structured environment

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

G. Cerebral Palsy

1. Group of disorders characterized by motor dysfunctions
2. Nurse assistant duties and responsibilities
 - a. Provide safe, structured environment
 - b. Apply appropriate assistive devices
 - c. Emphasize individual strengths
 - d. Encourage independence
 - e. Treat with dignity
 - f. Respect privacy

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

H. Alcoholism/Drug Abuse

1. Abuse of alcohol or drugs when healthy coping mechanisms have failed
2. 15% of elderly suffer from alcoholism
3. Often triggered by
 - a. Retirement
 - b. Loss of self-esteem
 - c. Loneliness
 - d. Chronic pain
 - e. Decline in health
 - f. Stress

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

4. Nurse Assistant duties and responsibilities

- a. Report to the licensed nurse any sign that the patient/resident is under the influence of alcohol or drugs
- b. Be sure alcohol/drugs are not available (alcohol can be in products such as aftershave, perfume, cooking extracts, cleaning products)
- c. Watch for mental impairment; loss of coordination, poor judgment
- d. Be careful when feeding, gag reflex may be impaired
- e. Set boundaries, avoid being manipulated
- f. Be aware of support groups such as Alcoholics Anonymous or the Mental Health Association
- g. Notify licensed nurse if signs of withdrawal
 - 1) Alcohol: tremors, shaking, agitation, seizures
 - 2) Drugs: runny nose, depression, headache, pacing, poor coping mechanisms, agitation
- h. Follow patient's/resident's care plan
- i. Be aware of dangerous behavior

Describe the special needs and changes of persons with developmental and mental disorders including intellectual disability, cerebral palsy, epilepsy, Parkinson's disease, and mental illness.

I. The Agitated Patient/resident

1. Uses inappropriate verbal, vocal, or motor activity due to causes other than disorientation or real need
2. Nurse Assistant duties and responsibilities
 - a. Report to the licensed nurse any signs of agitation including aimless wandering, pacing, cursing, screaming, spitting, biting, fighting, arguing, demanding, and talking to self
 - b. Maintain quiet, calm atmosphere
 - c. Encourage distracting activities
 - d. Check for constipation or other sources of discomfort/pain
 - e. Realize that patient/resident may become more agitated due to feelings of loss of control
 - f. Avoid restraints
 - g. Allow patient/resident to walk, or rock in chair to diffuse energy
 - h. Listen with empathy
 - i. Make sure you stay safe - maintain area to escape (don't let patient/resident get between you and the door)
 - j. Call for help if patient/resident gets violent
 - k. Do not attempt to control patient/resident if they become violent
 - l. Redirect

Describe the special needs of persons with Alzheimer's Disease and other related dementias

A. Explain the causes and differences of delirium, depression and dementia

- a. Dementia is a general term for a decline in mental ability severe enough to interfere with daily life
- b. Dementia describes a group of symptoms affecting memory, thinking and social abilities severely enough to interfere with your daily life
- c. Not a specific disease, but several different diseases may cause dementia
- d. Delirium is a serious disturbance in mental abilities that results in confused thinking and reduced awareness of the environment
- e. Depression is a mood disorder that causes a persistent feeling of sadness and loss of interest, which affects how you feel, think and behave, and can lead to a variety of emotional and physical problems
- f. Dementia and delirium may be particularly difficult to distinguish, and a person may have both
- g. Causes not known exactly known, but as with many mental disorders, a variety of factors may be involved, such as:
 - b) Brain chemistry
 - c) Hormones
 - d) Traumatic or stressful events
 - e) Abuse of alcohol or recreational drugs
 - f) Serious or chronic illness, including cancer, stroke, chronic pain or heart disease
 - g) Certain medications or drug toxicity

Describe the special needs of persons with Alzheimer's Disease and other related dementias

A. Explain the causes and differences of delirium, depression and dementia

h) Malnutrition or dehydration

i) Sleep deprivation

h. Common signs and symptoms include:

1) Memory loss, which is usually noticed by a spouse or someone else

2) Difficulty communicating or finding words

3) Difficulty with visual and spatial abilities, such as getting lost while driving

4) Difficulty reasoning or problem-solving

5) Difficulty handling complex tasks

6) Difficulty with planning and organizing

7) Difficulty with coordination and motor functions

8) Confusion and disorientation

9) Personality changes

10) Anxiety

11) Paranoia

12) Agitation

13) Hallucinations

Describe the special needs of persons with Alzheimer's Disease and other related dementias

B. Describe the signs, symptoms and progression of Alzheimer's disease and other dementias

1. Alzheimer's disease (covered in objective 7: neurological section): caused by plaques and tangles in the brain's nervous system. Brain decreases in size as cells are lost. Progressive and incurable

2. Signs and Symptoms

a. Stage 1: Mild Dementia

- 1) Short-term memory loss
- 2) Personality changes
- 3) Disorientation to time
- 4) Poor judgment
- 5) Lack of safety awareness
- 6) Careless in appearance
- 7) Anxious, depressed
- 8) Delusions of persecution

b. Stage 2: Moderate Dementia

- 1) Increased short-term memory loss
- 2) Complete disorientation
- 3) Wandering and pacing
- 4) Sundowning
- 5) Perseveration phenomena
- 6) Motor skills deteriorate
- 7) Speech, reading, writing deteriorates
- 8) Incontinent of bowel and bladder
- 9) Catastrophic episode

c. Severe Dementia

- 1) Totally dependent
- 2) Verbally unresponsive
- 3) May have seizures

Describe the special needs of persons with Alzheimer's Disease and other related dementias

C. Explain the nursing care received by persons with Alzheimer's disease and other dementias

- a. Protect patient/resident from injury
- b. Be compassionate, patient, and calm; maintain sense of humor
- d. Encourage independence as long as possible
- e. Provide mental and physical activities within resident's capabilities
- f. Support resident's dignity and self-esteem
- g. Provide structured quiet environment that is uncluttered
- h. Use appropriate body language; resident's will "read" the staff's behavior and reflect the mood of the staff in their own behavior
- i. Give one, short, simple direction at a time
- j. Observe for signs and symptoms of physical ailments; resident may be unaware of illness

k. Assist residents to maintain a dignified, attractive appearance by helping with grooming and dressing

l. Monitor food and fluid intake

- a) Do not use plastic feeding utensils
- b) Provide nutritious finger foods when the resident is unable to use utensils
- c) Be aware of swallowing difficulties
- d) Prepare food (butter bread, cut into bites) and encourage resident to feed self as long as possible
- e) Check food temperatures
- f) Check resident's mouth after eating for "pocketing" (hoarding food in the cheeks)
- g) Weigh residents to detect patterns of weight gain or loss
- m. Use touch appropriately; surprising resident can result in a catastrophic reaction
- n. Avoid using logic, reasoning or lengthy explanations
- o. When ability to speak is lost, resident may communicate through non-verbal means
 - a. Biting, scratching, and kicking to express displeasure
 - b. Facial expressions and body language may express moods

Describe the special needs of persons with Alzheimer's Disease and other related dementias

D. Identify specific activities that would improve the quality of life for persons with Alzheimer's disease and other dementias

- a. Use distraction and diversion when resident is agitated, take hand and calmly walk to another activity
- b. Realize that people with dementia are not responsible for what they say
 - 1) They cannot change
 - 2) They are not aware of what they are doing
 - 3) They have poor impulse control
 - 4) Allow them to "save face" by preserving their dignity
 - 5) No one really knows what is happening in the mind of people with dementia
- c. Compliment positive behavior and accomplishments
- d. Encourage rocking chairs to diffuse nervous energy

Describe the special needs of persons with Alzheimer's Disease and other related dementias

E. Identify specific safety measures for Alzheimer's and dementia populations

- a. Use reality orientation (R.O.) to regain connection to environment
 - 1) Especially effective in 1st stages of Alzheimer's
 - 2) Use clock and calendar at bedside
 - 3) Call by name
- b. Answer questions honestly, but do not give information they are unable to handle; for example
 - 1) The resident asks if their deceased husband is coming to visit
 - 2) Nurse Assistant could respond by saying "tell me about your husband"
- c. Do not argue with resident's reality
- d. Use bulletin boards decorated for the season
- e. Keep curtains open during the day
- f. Make sure they have their glasses and hearing aids on
- g. Do not expect resident to remember you - identify yourself, as needed
- h. Incorporate validation therapy into all your interactions with dementia resident (maintains disorientated person's dignity by acknowledging the person's memories and feeling)
- i. Use reminiscing therapy
- j. Incorporate music therapy
- k. Incorporate animal therapy

Describe the special needs of persons with Alzheimer's Disease and other related dementias

F. Identify *at-risk* behaviors that include modifiable and non-modifiable factors, as well as increased risk for abuse

- a. Research has shown that the same risk factors associated with heart disease may also increase the risk of Alzheimer's disease. These include:
- b. Lack of exercise
- c. Obesity
- d. Smoking or exposure to secondhand smoke
- e. High blood pressure
- f. High cholesterol
- g. Poorly controlled type 2 diabetes
- h. sleep patterns
- i. Age
- j. Family history and genetics